

THE **CARD-COUNTING MOTIVATOR CHECKLIST**



Mastering the skills in this checklist makes the difference between being perpetually broke and taking millions from casinos. There are no shortcuts. These items should be done in conjunction with our Video Course, not as a replacement for watching the video course. Each section of the Video Course has action steps to aid you in your training process. This checklist will help you make sure you're moving forward methodically in your card counting training and joining the elite community of successful card counters.

BASIC STRATEGY

Repeat these 3 steps until you can play perfect basic strategy. This is the absolute foundation to card counting. Do not proceed to the next steps until you're perfect at basic strategy.

- ◆ Fill out (2) [Two Blank Charts](#) every day
- ◆ Recite it verbally 2x/day (10x/day is even better!)
- ◆ Play the [Basic Strategy Training Drill](#) a minimum of 200 hands/day

CARD COUNTING

Repeat these 4 steps until you can keep the running count perfectly.

Continue to practice basic strategy

- ◆ Count through a deck of cards.
- ◆ Remove 1 facedown card from a deck, count down the remaining 51 cards. At the end, check your running count. If you have a +1, verify that the facedown card was a 10, J, K, Q, or Ace. If you have a 0, verify that the facedown card was a 7, 8, or 9. If you have a -1, verify that the removed card was a 2, 3, 4, 5 or 6. Do this until you can perform it perfectly within 30 seconds
- ◆ Play the [Card Counting](#) drill a minimum of 2 shoes/day (The more the better!)
- ◆ Back-count at a casino. Go to a casino and just watch. **DO NOT PLAY**. Don't even bring money to play with. Just watch and count down tables. This will help you adjust your counting to real life casino conditions.

BASIC STRATEGY + COUNTING

Practice Until Perfect

- ◆ Use the [Free Play](#) drill or our [iOS App](#) or have a friend deal to you. Check the count after every round to make sure you are not making mistakes. If you make a mistake, try to figure out what happened so you can eliminate the mistake moving forward.

TRUE COUNT CONVERSION

Practice Until Perfect.

- ◆ Play the [True Count Drill](#) to practice dividing the running count by the number of decks remaining. Start with Full Decks. When that gets easy, move on to half deck divisors (decks remaining)
- ◆ You can create the same drill manually with a discard tray, 6 decks of cards, and a hat or bowl with the numbers 1-30 written on them. Just set the discard tray to 6 decks remaining (less than a deck in the discard tray), and pull numbers out of the hat/bowl until you've done every number. Then repeat with 5, 4, 3, 2, and 1 deck divisors (decks remaining).

DEVIATIONS

Practice Until Perfect.

- ◆ Print out a Deviation Chart and start reciting deviations (choose [S17](#) or [H17](#), depending on the game you will most often be playing). Make sure you understand what each deviation means.
- ◆ Fill out [Blank Charts](#) with both Basic Strategy AND Deviations
- ◆ Be able to recite deviations as a sentence. For example: "Basic strategy is to never split 10's against a 6, but at a true count of 4 or higher you will split 10's against a 6." You can find the deviations explained on our [Deviations page](#).
- ◆ Use the [Deviation Drill](#) until you can play it perfectly for at least 100 hands.

BANKROLL MANAGEMENT

- ◆ Make sure you know your betting strategy. We provide custom Bankroll Coaching, or you can base your decisions off of the situation that best reflects your bankroll size in this document: blackjackapprenticeship.com/recommended-blackjack-bankroll/



BONUS TIPS

- ◆ Don't play in a casino until these steps are mastered. It will just be a distraction
- ◆ Don't brag about big wins. Even gamblers have big wins. Wins aren't the goal right now... perfect blackjack is. And Perfect blackjack leads to a winning game.
- ◆ Don't skip steps. I know counting is more sexy than basic strategy. But basic strategy is the foundation. The better you are at basic strategy, the better card counter you will be. Trust us.

Holy freaking crap! You've made it further than most people who've dabbled in card counting. If you've made it this far, you are well on your way to beating the casinos! Hopefully by now you've started networking on the Forum and researching playing conditions for casinos near you on Casino411. Let us know how we can continue to help you beat the casinos!